# Good work deserves a closer look.

The grain you choose. The joint you refine. The care someone will live with for years.

We're building a place where those decisions become part of how furniture is discovered. We'd like you to help shape it.

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15

## Founding makers. A say in the beginning.

A personal invitation from Kody and Leah Kochaver, Madison, Wisconsin.

Apply to Partner

The app and marketplace are pre-launch.
Where Time Adds Value.



Hiawatha, a Middle West Studio project. Design: Leah Kochaver. Photography: Ashley Hicks.
Shown as a reference to Leah's design practice, not a Patina marketplace listing.

# Tools should feel part of the work.

I'm building Patina because the tools around furniture discovery often feel disconnected from the creative process. There is care in choosing a piece, understanding a material and imagining how it will live in a room. I want the experience to make room for that care.

Leah brings the judgment of a working interior designer through her practice at Middle West Studio. I bring the product and technology work. Together, we're building a designer-taught way to find furniture that belongs, with a path to working with a designer when someone wants to take it further.

The people who make the furniture belong in that conversation from the beginning. I'd love to understand your work, and what you think a better experience should make possible.

# Kody

Kody Kochaver / Technology & Product
Leah Kochaver / Design & Experience

# Help shape the way your work is seen.

## 01 A designer's point of view.

We're building discovery around a focused selection and a working designer's judgment. Our aim is to help homeowners and the designers they work with understand a piece: its proportion, its presence and the care in its construction.

## 02 Your voice beside the work.

You know why a material was chosen, how a joint works and what a finish will become with use. Those details should come from you. We want the reasons behind a piece to be part of its introduction.

## 03 A say in the beginning.

The first makers can bring practical workshop realities into the conversation while Patina is being built: how work is represented, what people need to know and where furniture discovery falls short today.

Earned placement. No sponsored slots. No pay-to-play.

We want to understand what makes a piece worth living with.

# Start with one piece.

Choose something that shows how you think. A finished piece, a work in progress or a portfolio link gives us somewhere useful to begin.

| | |
|---|---|
| The form | What makes its proportions, silhouette or presence yours? |
| The material | What did you choose, where does it come from, and why does it suit this piece? |
| The construction | Which joint, edge or technique would you point out if we visited the workshop? |
| A life of use | How should someone care for it? What changes with time, and what can be repaired? |
| The practical details | Where do you work? What are your current lead times, delivery area, customization options and existing trade arrangements? |

## Bring what already exists.

A current website, Instagram page or image gallery is a useful start. There is no image-upload requirement in the application; links and a clear description can introduce the work.

# Tell us what you make.

The application starts a conversation. You do not need to prepare a separate presentation.

## Have these details ready

Workshop name and location.
Primary specialty and years of experience.
Contact name and email.
A short description of your craft.

## Useful, if you have them

Website or portfolio links.
Existing trade arrangements.
Sourcing and sustainability practices.
A phone number for follow-up.

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01

### Send your application.

Share the essentials at patina.cloud/makers/apply.

02

### Look for a note from Kody.

The automatic email confirms receipt. Kody reviews applications personally with Leah.

03

### Hear from us within two weeks.

We'll reply with a clear next step and, where there's a fit, begin discussing what a partnership could look like.

Apply to Partner

patina.cloud/makers/apply

Questions first? hello@patina.cloud

# A clear beginning.

## Is the marketplace open?

The app and marketplace are pre-launch. We're bringing together the people and work that will shape them. This is a founding invitation, not a promise of immediate sales.

## What does "the first 15" mean?

We're bringing together a founding group of 15 makers whose approach to materials and construction fits Patina. Every application is reviewed personally.

## Can makers pay for placement?

No. There are no sponsored placements or pay-to-play slots. The quality of the work and its fit with Patina are the starting point.

## What are the commercial terms?

Fees, commissions, exclusivity and operating terms are not set out in this invitation. We'll discuss the proposed scope and terms together before either side agrees to a partnership.

## Does applying mean I've been accepted?

No. The first email acknowledges receipt. Kody and Leah review applications personally and reply within two weeks with a next step.

## What would you need from me after that?

We would begin by understanding your work and your existing way of doing business. Any further content, product information or participation would be discussed as part of the proposed partnership.

# Bring your work to the conversation.

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